



# **Gamma RP**

## **1st Edition**

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expansible

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# Introduction

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Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from world-building.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual scarcity of free time, I naturally decided to spend a few years creating ΓRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting before actually sitting down and playing with my friends.

The ΓRP system and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together for anyone else that may want to use the pre-built setting.

I heavily encourage any users of this system to build their own settings on top of this system.

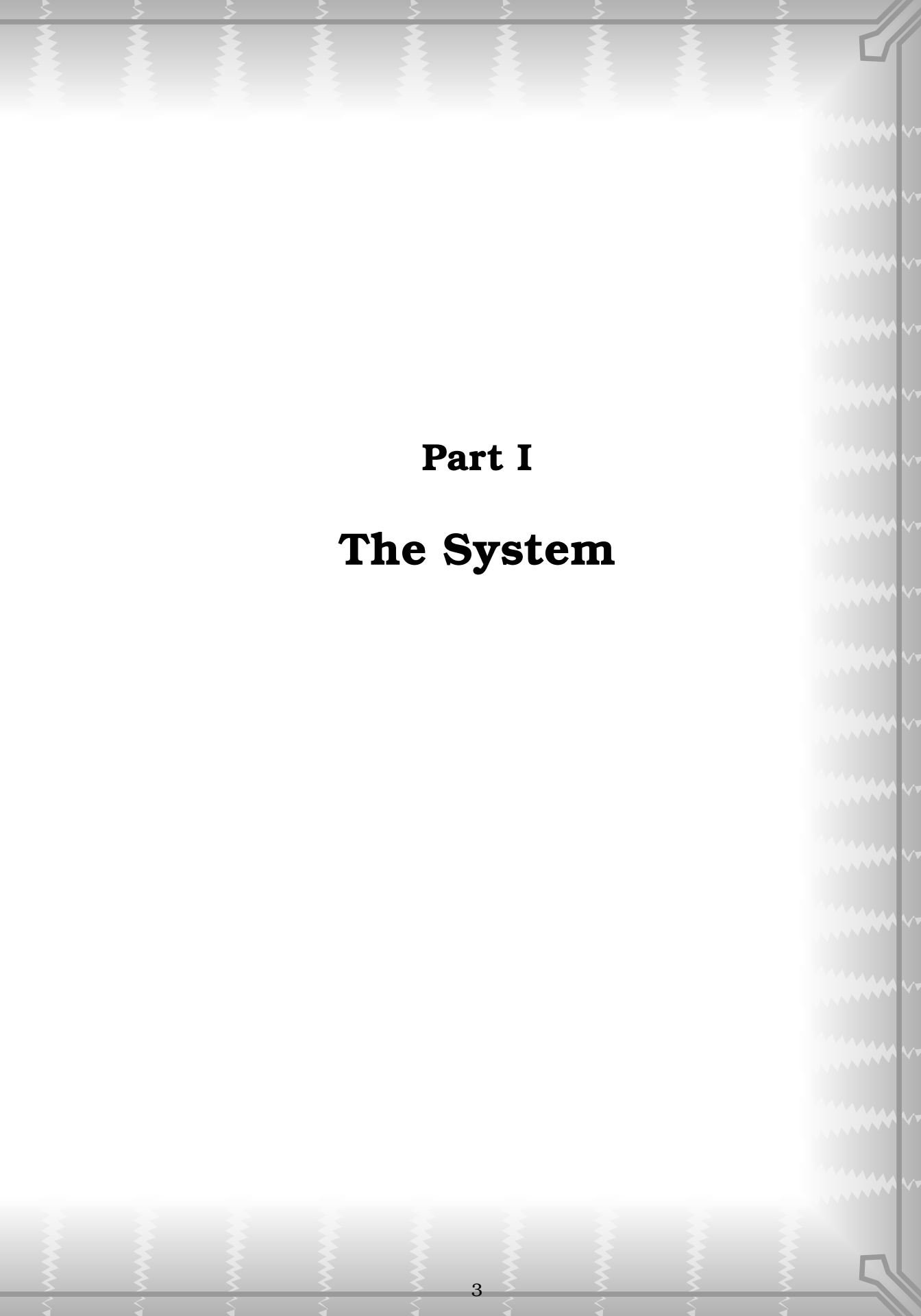
I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

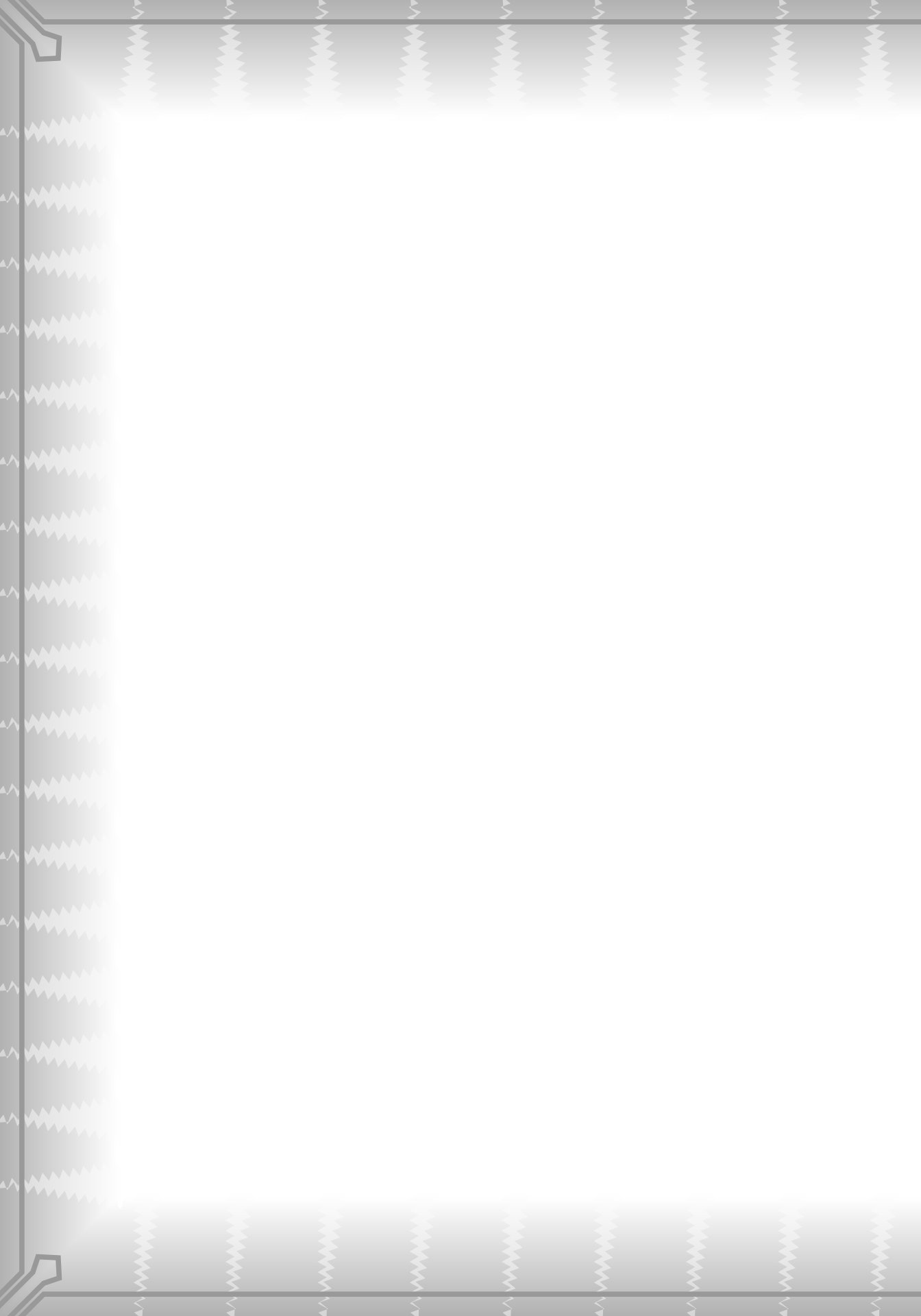
Gamma RP, or  ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator





# **Part I**

## **The System**





## 2 The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character—a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if there is an element of chance in deciding how a scene unfolds. TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether an unsure course of action is successful.



The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice, and rolls several at a time. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop (rather than one of the increasingly popular virtual ones), you may want to obtain at least a dozen 12 sided dice for convenience. It is possible to play with fewer dice by rolling one die at a time.

### 2.1 Dice Rolling Basics

The notation for a roll in TRP is written as  $RXaY$ , which verbally is pronounced as “Roll  $X$  a  $Y$ ”

- $X$  is the number of dice you roll.

- $Y$  is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates that the top  $Y$  numbers of a die pass the success threshold.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success.

The quickest way to judge if your advantaged roll is a success is:

1. Add the advantage to the value of each die in your roll
2. If  $[\text{ADVANTAGE}] + [\text{DIE VALUE}] > 12$  for any die in your roll, your roll is a success.

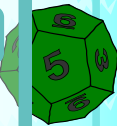
An advantage of 0 is the exception to this:  $RXa0$  is still successful if any of the dice roll a 12. Both larger  $X$  and larger  $Y$  indicate a higher probability of success.



Let's look at a few example rolls.

Table 2a: Advantage Examples

| ROLL | DICE        | RESULT  |
|------|-------------|---------|
| R5a1 | ① ① ① ⑧ ④ ⑩ | FAILURE |
| R5a1 | ① ① ② ⑫ ②   | SUCCESS |
| R4a1 | ① ① ⑧ ⑩     | FAILURE |
| R4a2 | ① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩     | SUCCESS |
| R4a3 | ① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩     | SUCCESS |
| R3a3 | ① ⑨ ⑧       | FAILURE |
| R3a4 | ① ⑨ ⑧       | SUCCESS |
| R3a8 | ② ④ ③       | FAILURE |
| R3a9 | ② ④ ③       | SUCCESS |



*Advantage* can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvan-*

tage which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of  $RXa(-Z)$  is written equivalently as  $RXdZ$ .

For a roll at *disadvantage* of  $Z$  to be successful, in addition to having at least one die in the roll land on 12, there must also be at least  $Z$  dice within the roll displaying a number above 1.

The quickest way to judge if your disadvantaged roll is a success is:

- 1. Check if there are any dice showing 12 in your roll
- 2. Count the number of dice that show a value above 1
- 3. If  $[NUMBER\ OF\ DICE\ ABOVE\ 1] > [DISADVANTAGE]$  for *any* die in your roll, and there is at least one die showing 12, your roll is a success.

Note that the rolls  $RXa1$ ,  $RXa0$ , and  $RXd1$  are all actually identical, with all three requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

Lets look at a few example disadvantage rolls.

Table 2b: Disadvantage Examples

| ROLL | DICE                                                                                                   | RESULT  |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| R2d1 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 2 <sub>2</sub>                                                                         | SUCCESS |
| R2d1 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 1 <sub>1</sub>                                                                         | SUCCESS |
| R2d2 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 1 <sub>1</sub>                                                                         | FAILURE |
| R4d1 | 11 8 1 10                                                                                              | FAILURE |
| R4d2 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 8 <sub>2</sub> 1 10 <sub>3</sub>                                                       | SUCCESS |
| R4d3 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 8 <sub>2</sub> 1 10 <sub>3</sub>                                                       | SUCCESS |
| R4d4 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 8 <sub>2</sub> 1 10 <sub>3</sub>                                                       | FAILURE |
| R8d7 | 12 <sub>1</sub> 12 <sub>2</sub> 1 12 <sub>3</sub> 12 <sub>4</sub><br>12 <sub>5</sub> 12 <sub>6</sub> 1 | FAILURE |

When the disadvantage is greater than or equal to the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure even if you have at least one dice showing a 12. If you are asked to make a roll with a disadvantage equal to or greater than the number of dice, you may simply declare a failure. However you may still make the roll if you have abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

Table 2c: Probability of success for various rolls

| $RXAY$ | $RXd6$ | $RXd5$ | $RXd4$ | $RXd3$ | $RXd2$ | $RXd1$ | $RXa0$ | $RXa1$ | $RXa2$ | $RXa3$ | $RXa4$ | $RXa5$ | $RXa6$ | $RXa7$ |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| R1aY   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 8.3%   | 8.3%   | 8.3%   | 16.7%  | 25.0%  | 33.3%  | 41.7%  | 50.0%  | 58.3%  |
| R2aY   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 15.3%  | 16.0%  | 16.0%  | 16.0%  | 30.6%  | 43.8%  | 55.6%  | 66.0%  | 75.0%  | 82.6%  |
| R3aY   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 20.4%  | 21.6%  | 23.0%  | 23.0%  | 23.0%  | 42.1%  | 57.8%  | 70.4%  | 80.2%  | 87.5%  | 92.8%  |
| R4aY   | 0.0%   | 0.0%   | 24.0%  | 25.7%  | 27.5%  | 29.4%  | 29.4%  | 29.4%  | 51.8%  | 68.4%  | 80.2%  | 88.4%  | 93.8%  | 97.0%  |
| R5aY   | 0.0%   | 26.4%  | 28.4%  | 30.5%  | 32.8%  | 35.3%  | 35.3%  | 35.3%  | 59.8%  | 76.3%  | 86.8%  | 93.2%  | 96.9%  | 98.7%  |
| R6aY   | 27.9%  | 30.1%  | 32.5%  | 35.0%  | 37.7%  | 40.7%  | 40.7%  | 40.7%  | 66.5%  | 82.2%  | 91.2%  | 96.1%  | 98.4%  | 99.5%  |

2.2 Modifying Rolls

Very often a character will have a default way they roll something in a situation, but the circumstances of the situation impair or improve their chances of suc-

cess.

When this happens, it is often easier as a GM to specify the roll they must make as a modification of the dice or advantage of their usual roll.

### 2.2.1 Bonus and Penalty Dice

You should only modify the number of dice for a characters sparingly or if the rulebook specifies that you should do so. Modifying the number of dice is described using the terms “die bonus” and “die penalty”.

If the rules specify you take a  $W$  die penalty- then you roll with  $W$  fewer dice than you ordinarily would. Die Penalties are abbreviated with  $\{-W\}$ , for instance- if you see  $\{-2\}$  after a roll, it means you take a 2 die penalty to that roll.

If the rules specify you take a  $X$  die bonus- then you roll with  $X$  more dice than you ordinarily would. Die Bonuses are abbreviated with  $\{+X\}$ , for instance- if you see  $\{+2\}$  after a roll, it means you have a 2 die bonus to that roll.

### 2.2.2 Additional Advantage and Disadvantage

Modifying the advantage and disadvantage on a roll may be done more freely by the GM than adding dice bonuses or penalties. If the situation is harder than usual, the GM may impose “additional disadvantage” on the players. If the situation has been modified to be easier than usual, the GM may grant “additional advantage” to the players.

If the GM or the rules specify you take  $Y$  additional advantage- then you roll with  $Y$  higher advantage than you ordinarily would. Additional Advantage is often abbreviated with  $\{aaY\}$ , for instance- if you see  $\{aa2\}$  after a roll, it means you roll with 2 additional advantage.

If the GM or the rules specify you take  $Z$  additional disadvantage- then you roll with  $Z$  lower advantage than you ordinarily would. Remember that  $-Z$  advantage is the same as  $Z$  disadvantage. Rolling with additional disadvantage may still leave some net advantage to the roll left over. Additional disadvantage is often abbreviated with  $\{ddZ\}$ , for instance-

if you see  $\{dd2\}$  after a roll, it means you roll with 2 additional disadvantage.

## 2.3 Group Rolls

Sometimes multiple characters must all individually perform the same task, in a way where their average performance impacts the success of the group. This often happens in situations where one character could catch another character if they fail, by performing well enough. Such a situation calls for a Group Roll.

The process of a Group Roll is as follows:

1. Each character making a Group Roll makes the corresponding roll for the task
2. Count the total number of successes among the group
3. If  $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}] \geq [\text{GROUP SIZE}]$  then the group succeeds at the roll.

If you need to count the number of successes for a Group Roll, it is  $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}]/[\text{GROUP SIZE}]$  rounded **down** to the nearest whole number.

This may be most easily illustrated with an example.

**GM:** As you enter the swamp, the mud grows deeper and harder to trudge through. You'll all have to use your Fortitude talent to pass without hurting yourselves.

**Alice:** Can we make this a Group Roll? I think we could catch each other if we fall.

**GM:** Absolutely. Make a Group Roll for **88 FORTITUDE**.

FORTITUDE GROUP ROLL

**Bob:** R2a3 - 8 3

**Alice:** R5a5 - 1 8 2 5 10

(continued...)

(...continued)

**Eve:** R6a4 - ③ ⑦ ⑫ ④ ① ②**GM:** Great. Between all of you you have 3 successes. Alice's extra success makes up for Bob's lack of success.

Bob- you stumble in the thick mud and almost land face first, but Alice catches you. You all struggle through and make it through the swamp without injury.

Other examples of situations where group rolls are appropriate include:

- Stealthily getting through a stretch of terrain
- Persuading someone that your group is trustworthy
- A coordinated group performance of any kind
- Crafting a large batch of items or cooking a large meal

## 2.4 Roll Contests

Sometimes, one character may struggle against another character or entity within the game. When this happens, the game enters a roll contest—both characters roll against each other.

The process of a roll contest is as follows:

1. Both characters make their roll simultaneously.
2. If one character is successful and the other is not, the successful character wins.
3. If both characters are unsuccessful, return to step 1.

4. If both characters are successful, the first character will be penalized dice equal to the number of successes of the second character, and vice versa. Return to step 1.

5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one character has no dice remaining, the character who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both characters reach 0 dice simultaneously, both characters lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

Step 6 is only important when one of the characters has an ability that imposes a penalty for failing a roll.

Roll Contests are probably best illustrated with an example as follows.

**Eve:** Can I initiate a grapple on the guard?**GM:** Sure! Go ahead and initiate a Roll Contest with  **ATHLETICS**.**Eve:** I'll use my Dexterity talent since I'm much better at that.**GM:** Sure, you can *talent proxy*. Use Dexterity at 2 additional disadvantage.

### ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 1

**Eve:** R6a2 - ③ ⑤ ⑨ ① ④ ⑤**Guard:** R4a4 - ② ⑧ ③ ②**Eve:** Shoot.**GM:** Don't worry, neither of you have any successes, so you'll roll again.

### ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 2

**Eve:** R6a2 - ⑨ ⑪ ⑦ ② ⑥ ③**Guard:** R4a4 - ⑨ ① ③ ⑩

(continued...)

(...continued)

**GM:** You grab the guard but he's wriggling out of your grasp. You'll roll with 2 fewer dice since he got 2 successes, and he'll roll with 1 fewer dice because you got 1 success. Go again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 3

**Eve:** R4a2 -    

**Guard:** R3a4 -   

**Eve:** Yes! I succeeded and the guard did not.

**GM:** Great! You deftly bend the guard's arm and twist him into your awaiting chokehold. You've grappled the guard.

It is highly disrecommended to perform a *Group Roll contest*. For tasks of that complexity it is usually better to let the game enter phased mode- which will be described in detail later.

If you do find yourself in a situation in which a Group Roll contest is called for, the process is as follows.

1. Both groups make their Group Rolls simultaneously.
2. If one group is successful and the other is not, the successful group wins.
3. If both groups are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
4. If both groups are successful, the first group must be penalized a number of dice equal to the second group's number of successes, and vice versa. Every character in the group takes this penalty. Then return to Step 1.
5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one group has no

dice remaining, the group who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both groups reach 0 dice simultaneously, both groups lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

## 2.5 Helping Rolls

Sometimes in a situation, a character may be able to help another character perform a task, such as lifting a heavy object, searching for insight into a puzzle, playing a game of chess, putting on a performance, or wrestling an opponent.

When this happens they may roll to help the other character. This is simpler than a Group Roll.

An helping roll is performed as follows:

1. Any character that is able to help and wants to help rolls the same talent or ability as the character making the initial roll.
2. The sum of all participating characters' successes, including the original character, is the number of successes for the original roll.
3. If the roll risks injury on failure, all of the participating characters will receive the injury.

Below is an example of a helping roll.

**GM:** Large Larry is *obstructing* the exit to this room. I've picked NPC defending actions. Player party, it's your offensive phase.

**Eve:** Wheeeeeeeeeeeeeee Write something here you ridiculous author!

When helping rolls are used for abilities other than base talents, the helping character must in general have and actively use the same ability as the character they are helping.

For instance, to help another character cast a particular spell, the helping character must know the same spell and use the same cast and consume a cast use.

In order to help another character use a specific augment ability, the helping character must have the same augment

active in their loadout and use the same ability.

Additionally, to help a character in phased mode who is using an ability that takes an action (offensive or defensive), the helping character must also consume an action to help.



## 3 Building a Character

The same character building process is used for non-player-characters (NPC's) and player characters (PC's). This chapter will indicate when something is nonessential for a non-player character.

For a step by step overview of the process of building a character, consider skipping to Section 3.8.

### 3.1 Fundamental Attributes

All characters have 6 fundamental attributes, divided into 3 *Foundations* and 3 *Characteristics*.

- **Foundations**–  
Mind, Body, Heart
- **Characteristics**–  
Precision, Strength, Grace

The foundations and characteristics are combined to form 9 fundamental *talents* that all characters have.

Table 3a: Combining Foundations and Characteristics to get Talents

|       | PRECISION                                 | STRENGTH                               | GRACE                               |
|-------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| MIND  | <b>MEMORY</b><br>R[MIND]a[PRECISION]      | <b>INTELLECT</b><br>R[MIND]a[STRENGTH] | <b>INSIGHT</b><br>R[MIND]a[GRACE]   |
| BODY  | <b>DEXTERITY</b><br>R[BODY]a[PRECISION]   | <b>FORTITUDE</b><br>R[BODY]a[STRENGTH] | <b>ATHLETICS</b><br>R[BODY]a[GRACE] |
| HEART | <b>PERCEPTION</b><br>R[HEART]a[PRECISION] | <b>WILL</b><br>R[HEART]a[STRENGTH]     | <b>CHARISMA</b><br>R[HEART]a[GRACE] |

When building a character, you have:

- 6 points to distribute among your foundations ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], [**HEART**]) as you see fit
- 8 points to distribute among your characteristics ([**PRECISION**], [**STRENGTH**], [**GRACE**]) as you see fit

You **must** allocate at least 1 point to each foundation and each characteristic.

The number of points you allocate to each fundamental attribute become the

value of that fundamental attribute for the lifetime of your character and may not be changed after character creation.

However, you can gain aptitude in each of the fundamental talents which give additional advantage to their rolls, and racial bonuses and skills may give you bonus dice on different rolls.

The 12 fundamental talents are meant to intuitively follow from their construction. If you are trying to determine what talents are applicable in a situation, sim-

ply consider:

- Does this situation need Precision, Strength, or Grace?
- Does this situation relate to the Body, the Heart, or the Mind?

Then, find the corresponding row and column on the talent grid, and roll that talent to determine success.

The GM ultimately determines if a talent applies in a narrative situation, and

sometimes there may be more than one talent that is equally applicable. If the player can make an argument that the GM finds reasonable for why a talent is reasonable in a situation, they may roll that talent.

For clarity, what follows are descriptions of all the talents along with some example situations where they apply. This is not a comprehensive list.

• **MEMORY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Mind, such as precise recall, exact pattern matching or recognition, or accurate calculation. Examples include:

- A character is trying to recall if they've seen a symbol before in their past
- A character is trying to determine which of two piles of material weighs more
- A character is trying to determine if a language or code they are hearing is one they've heard before.
- A character is trying to memorize instructions for a complex process

• **INTELLECT**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Mind– such as intense computation or decisions involving many simultaneous variables. Examples include:

- A character is trying to decode a coded message
- A character is coming up with the solution to a puzzle
- A character needs to beat another character in a game of chess

• **INSIGHT**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Mind, such as nimble thinking or problems requiring the right inspiration to strike in a timely manner. Examples include:

- A character is investigating a crime scene
- A character is trying to invent a mechanism to close a door based on objects strewn around the area
- A character is trying to discern the political motivations of an organization
- A character is trying to escape a trap or legal dilemma

• **DEXTERITY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Body– think along the lines of quick and accurate reflexes. Examples include:

- Aiming a ranged weapon at a moving target

(continued...)



(...continued)

- Catching a rapidly moving small object
- Disarming a delicate trap without triggering it
- **FORTITUDE**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Body– think along the lines of endurance and raw physical power. Examples include:
  - Withstanding the effects of a strong alcoholic drink
  - Carrying a heavy object for a period of time
  - Wading through thick mud or pushing through tangled vines
- **ATHLETICS**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Body– think along the lines of well developed martial form or postural technique. Examples include:
  - Throwing an object as far as possible
  - Arm wrestling another character
  - Rolling out of a fall to mitigate damage
- **PERCEPTION**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Heart. This applies to the accuracy of a character’s emotional inspiration. Examples include:
  - Determining if another character is lying
  - Accurately guessing why another character is acting strange
  - Figuring out what is meaningful to another character
- **WILL**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Heart. This applies to determination and emotional centered-ness. Examples include:
  - A character is trying to withstand a psychic attack (or puppy-dog eyes)
  - A character is trying to power through pain to maintain focus on a task
  - A character is trying to resist the effects of a sedative
- **CHARISMA**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Heart. This can be thought of the character’s ability to navigate emotional issues and convince other people to follow their lead. Examples include:
  - Persuading another character to give up an item
  - Rallying a crowd to perform an action
  - Deceiving another character about something

### 3.1.1 Talent Proxying

The various talents in ITRP have significant conceptual overlap. In addition to the GM determining what talents are appropriate to a situation, players are allowed to use talents on the opposite side

of the talent grid at 2 additional disadvantage. This is called talent proxying.

This encapsulates the fact that vastly different skills may be used to accomplish the same feat. For instance, the ability to remember details about what motivates people can substitute for the

ability to appeal to their emotions, and in this way, the **MEMORY** talent may proxy for the **CHARISMA** talent. Fast enough reflexes would allow you to adjust your body in the right way to accomplish martial feats that would usually require well developed form. Conversely, well developed form can substitute for fast and accurate reflexes. Therefore **DEXTERITY** and **ATHLETICS** can proxy for each other. **FORTITUDE** may be proxied with ei-

ther **INTELLECT**, **DEXTERITY**, **WILL**, or **ATHLETICS** at 4 additional disadvantage.

This represents the fact that physical problem solving (Intellect), accurate enough reflexes (Dexterity), dogged enough determination (Will), or well developed form (Athletics), can all substitute for raw power.

What follows are visual diagrams showing what talents can be proxied for others.

Figure 3a: Talents you can proxy at -2a

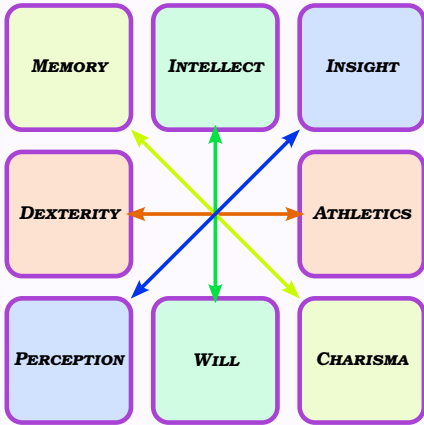
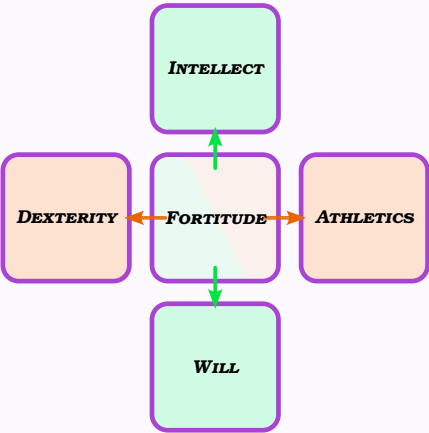


Figure 3b: Talents you can proxy at -4a



You can gain aptitude in your talents by spending experience points, or XP for short. Each aptitude gives 1 additional advantage when rolling the talent.

It costs:

- 1 XP for the first aptitude
- 2 XP for the second aptitude
- 3 XP for the third aptitude

You may have a maximum of 3 aptitude in any talent.

### 3.1.2 Depleting Fundamentals

In a pinch, you may *deplete* your foundations and your characteristics for certain bonuses.

Each time you *deplete* a fundamental, you incur an additional -1 penalty to that fundamental. This penalty persists until you next take the *sleep* downtime action. You may not deplete your foundations or characteristics below 0.

Note that if you deplete your **[MIND]**, **[BODY]**, or **[HEART]** to 0 you will **automatically fail all rolls related to these foundations**. You may still proxy a related talent to avoid failing the roll.

Depleting 2 foundations (**[MIND]**, **[BODY]**, or **[HEART]**) to 0 causes a character to fall *unconscious*. Your character may return to consciousness by having

one of their foundations restored.

Depleting all 3 foundations ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], and [**HEART**]) to 0, *kills* a character. If your character is dead- talents, abilities and items that normally restore foundation depletion will not work, and they must be restored to life by other means.

Any or all of a character's characteristics ([**PRECISION**], [**STRENGTH**], or [**GRACE**]) may be depleted to 0 without penalty.

## 3.2 Wounds

Each time a character receives a wound, they must choose a foundation ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], or [**HEART**]) to deplete by 1.

Healing wounds in this system is done by abilities that restore depleted foundations.

The **Robust** skill (described in Section 3.7) allows a character to take some wounds before depleting foundations.

### 3.2.1 Injuries

An injury is a specific type of wound which is applied directly to one specific foundation (one of [**MIND**], [**BODY**], or [**HEART**]).

The GM decides if a task has a risk of injury. Injuries are incurred specifically to the foundation related to the talent used for the failed task.

Failed **MEMORY**, **INTELLECT**, and **INSIGHT** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**MIND**].

Failed **DEXTERITY**, **FORTITUDE**, and **ATHLETICS** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**BODY**].

Failed **PERCEPTION**, **WILL**, and **CHARISMA** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**HEART**].

The Robust skill still protects you from injuries if you have wounds left that can be allocated to the Robust skill.

## 3.3 Species Bonuses

The species of a character provides bonuses to some of their talents.

The species bonuses are described for each species in Chapter ??.

## 3.4 Archetypes

Your character has an archetype- a way that their luck tends to run. This consists of a general type of *situation* and the type of *fortune* they have in this situation.

Your character starts with 1 archetype rank, and additional ranks may be added for 3 XP each. You may have a maximum of 5 archetype ranks.

You may choose to accumulate bonus archetype ranks above your usual maximum by *depleting* 1 from Grace for each bonus rank.

### Situations:

- **Social**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to influence the actions or words of other characters in the world around them. Recieve +1 to [**GRACE**].
- **Technical**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to create or modify something in the world around them. Recieve +1 to [**PRECISION**].
- **Martial**- all circumstances in which the character is in combat or physical contest (with the environment or another player). Recieve +1 to [**STRENGTH**].

(continued...)

(...continued)

**Fortunes:**

- **Adept**– For any roll in your situation, you may adjust any die by up to [RANKS] values AFTER rolling.
- **Awkward**– Up to [RANKS] times a day, you may choose to automatically fail a roll in your situation in order to gain 4 bonus dice on your next roll (in any situation).
- **Confident**– Once a day, after making a successful roll in a situation, you may choose to gain 6 advantage for the next [RANKS] consecutive subsequent rolls in that situation. You must do this before seeing the results of any of the subsequent rolls.
- **Duplicitious**– When your character is in a contested roll in the situation, you may swap up to [RANKS] of your rolled dice with your opponent's rolled dice (even if your opponent is inanimate or the environment). Your number of successes still depend on how much advantage you had on your original roll, and your opponent's number of successes still depend on how much advantage they had in their original roll.
- **Judicious**– Roll [RANKS] dice at the beginning of the day. You maintain a pool of [RANKS] dice that starts initially populated by your first rolls. In any archetype situation- you may swap any number of dice in your pool with dice in your roll, AFTER seeing the result.
- **Lucky**– A number of times equal to your number of archetype ranks, you may choose to automatically succeed on a roll in this situation. You must choose to do this before seeing the result of the roll.
- **Oblivious**– Up to [RANKS] times a day in your character's situation, you may ignore a roll and force a reroll, AFTER seeing the result, and you may reverse decisions about whether you used another ability to alter the dice roll before rerolling it.

## 3.5 Loadout Overview

A character's *loadout* refers to the set of equipment and abilities that they currently have access to. In FRP these are split into three categories: Casts, Augments, and Equipment.

Since there are numerous options for each of the loadout categories, this section will simply describe the function of each loadout category without listing all the options. For more details on various loadout options, skip to Chapter ??.

For NPC's a GM may consider skipping fully defining a loadout. In most sit-

uations an NPC will function even if the loadout has sections that are not defined.

### 3.5.1 Casts

*Casts* are special abilities that may be used a limited number of times each day.

A character may only have a fixed number of *prepared casts*. On creation, a character's [MAX PREP] is equal to their [MIND] score. They may prep more casts than this by depleting their [MIND] score by 1 for each additional cast prepared. The [MIND] score depleted by overprepping casts may be restored by unprepping

these casts.

In order to prepare a cast, a character must possess a cast focus corresponding to that cast. Most cast focuses are Wt 0 and cost 100 gold. Once a cast focus is in a character's possession it may be used as many times as desired to prepare that cast. A cast focus may be spell notes that a character has written themselves, or a series of runes that they use to imbue themselves with power, or even a device they activate which creates an effect on demand.

A character may only activate any of their prepared casts a fixed number of times between downtimes. On creation, a character's **[MAX CASTS]** is equal to their **[PRECISION]**.

To be clear, all of these cast activations may be due to the same cast being used, but a character may only cast a number of times equal to **[MAX CASTS]** without penalty. They may cast more than their usual max by depleting their **[PRECISION]** by 1 for each time they exceed **[MAX CASTS]**.

Options for casts in the base system are specified in Section ??.

### 3.5.2 Augments

*Augments* are devices, implants, or enhanced body features that grant a character extra abilities.

A character's **[MAX AUGMENTS]**, the number of augments they may have active without penalty, is initially equal to their **[HEART]** score. They may have more active augments than their **[MAX AUGMENTS]** by depleting their **[HEART]** score for one by every additional augment they keep active. The **[HEART]** score depleted by overactivating augments can be restored by deactivating augments over the limit.

Each augment in general gives a character access to one ability.

The exception is *attunements* which are special augments that give a character access to a skill tree that can be

invested in with XP. Each attunement counts as **two** augments. Attunements can be very powerful but can be riskier if a character is *disabled* and has to deactivate an attunement, they will lose access to the entire skill tree provided by an augment.

Options for augments in the base system are specified in Section ??

### 3.5.3 Equipment

On creation, a character's **[EQUIP Wt]**, the total weight of equipment they can have actively equipped is equal to their **[BODY]** score. If a character equips equipment in excess of the **[EQUIP Wt]**, they will *deplete* their **[BODY]** score by 1 for each additional weight unit of equipment they equip. The **[BODY]** score depleted by overequipping equipment may be restored by unequipping the additional equipment.

Equipment is divided into armor and implements. Implements include weapons, tools, and accessories, as well as any other items that may need to be rapidly accessed, manipulated, or wielded during *phased* mode. A character may only have one piece of armor equipment actively equipped. A character may have any number of implweapons, tools and accessories actively equipped as long as the sum of their weights does not exceed the character's **[EQUIP Wt]**.

Only actively equipped items may be accessed without penalty when the game is in *phased* mode.

On creation, a character's **[PACK Wt]**, total weight of things they can have in their personal inventory (aside from equipment you currently have actively equipped) is equal to their **[STRENGTH]** score. Having more weight than this in their inventory will *deplete* their **[STRENGTH]** score by 1 for each additional weight unit of items they have in their inventory. The **[STRENGTH]** score depleted by carrying too many items may be re-



stored by dropping items in their inventory.

Options for equipment in the base system are specified in Section ??.

### 3.5.4 Changing Loadout

If you change your loadout of active augments, inventory items, or prepped casts during *phased* (turn-based) gameplay, you will *deplete* your [**GRACE**] score. You may change your actively equipped items without penalty during phased gameplay, but note that pulling items out of your pack to do so will still deplete your [**GRACE**].

You can change any part of your loadout without penalty during *open* (non-turn-based) gameplay however many times you like.

## 3.6 Languages

Languages may be modified to be setting specific in FRP, but there are 6 languages that are referred to in the base system listed in this section.

A character starts knowing Standard, and depending on your character's species may know one other language by default. Your character may learn a new language by investing 2XP.

- **Standard**– A common language spoken by most sentient creatures. A cultural relic of a vast fallen empire which used to rule the setting.
- **Leesong**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Avian species.
- **Chitter**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Weaver Species.
- **Wake**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Aquatic species.
- **Slewbask**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Reptilian species.
- **Prineu**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Homonid species.

The GM may add languages and dialects beyond these to their setting as they see fit

## 3.7 Skills

Skills are things your character has trained in which confer various benefits. You must invest in skills with XP in order to use them.  
It costs:

- 1 XP for the first rank in a skill
- 2 XP for the second rank in a skill
- 3 XP for the third rank in a skill.

Each skill may only be listed once (with the exception of the “Experienced” skill), and you may have a maximum of 3 ranks in any skill.

What follows are descriptions of all the skills your character can take.

- **Augment Mastery**– for each rank in augment mastery, you may increase your **[MAX AUGMENTS]** by one.
- **Marathon Caster**– for each rank in marathon caster, you may increase your **[MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS]** by one
- **Versatile Caster**– for each rank in versatile caster, you may increase your **[MAX PREPARED CASTS]** by one.
- **Robust**– you may take wounds up to **[RANKS]** in Robust without depleting any of your fundamentals. Once you exceed this number of wounds you will start depleting fundamentals as usual in response to sustaining a wound.
- **Porter**– for each rank in porter, you may increase your **[PACK Wt]** by 1.
- **Walking Armory**– for each rank in Walking Armory, you may increase your **[EQUIP Wt]** by 1.
- **Linguist**– Whenever you must roll for any sort of communication involving a language your character does not know, you may do so with **[RANKS]** additional advantage.
- **Experienced in [topic]**– pick a topic your character is experienced in. The topic must be much more specific than "social," "martial," or "technical." Whenever your character is rolling in a situation relating to this topic, gain **[RANKS]** bonus dice to your roll. You may take this skill multiple times as long as the topic is unique for each listing.

Examples of topics for Experienced:

- Unarmed combat
- A specific class of spaceships
- A specific type of magic
- A specific type of weapon
- A specific culture
- A specific technology

The GM of a game can decide if the topic your character has picked is specific enough for the Experienced skill. If a topic you've already chosen seems too broad after a few sessions of play, the GM can ask you to narrow your topic. If a topic you've chosen seems too narrow after a few sessions of play, you may ask the GM to broaden your topic.

## 3.8 Character Building Overview

For convenience, this section is a consolidated step-by-step guide to building a character. You may follow along with the example character sheet at the end of this

section.

1. Chose your Fundamentals. Your foundations (**[HEART]**, **[BODY]**, and **[MIND]**) should all sum up to 6. Your characteristics (**[PRECISION]**, **[STRENGTH]**, **[GRACE]**) should all sum up to 8. The minimum value

of any of these fundamentals is 1.

2. Choose a species. Apply any bonuses to talents by writing them in the corresponding box labeled with {+}. Take note of any species abilities.
3. Write “Standard” in your languages. If your species gives you another language by default, write this in your languages as well.
4. Set your [**MAX CASTS**] to your [**PRECISION**] score, and set your [**MAX PREP**] to your [**MIND**] score.
5. Set your [**EQUIP Wt**] to your [**BODY**] score, and set your [**PACK Wt**] to your [**STRENGTH**] score.
6. Set your [**MAX AUGMENTS**] to your [**HEART**] score.
7. Start with 12 XP. Invest as you see fit in various abilities, or save them for later.
8. Start with 100 gold. Invest in equipment as you see fit, or save it for later.
9. Choose a number of casts less than or equal to your [**MAX PREP**] and write them in your list of prepped casts. Place corresponding cast focuses in the cast focus section of your Pack.
10. Choose a number of augments less than or equal to your [**MAX AUGMENTS**] and write them in your list of augments.
11. If you have taken the robust skill, you can put the number of skill ranks you have in robust in the smaller box of the “Wounds” section of the character sheet.
12. Discard items of your choice in your pack until the total weight of pack items is less than or equal to [**PACK Wt**].



Character Name

Species Abilities

Species

XP

Archetype

Used Ranks Bonus

CHARACTERISTICS

[WOUNDS]

[PRECISION]

[STRENGTH]

[GRACE]

[MIND]

MEMORY

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

INTELLECT

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

INSIGHT

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

[BODY]

DEXTERITY

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

FORTITUDE

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

ATHLETICS

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

[HEART]

PERCEPTION

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

WILL

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

CHARISMA

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

Armor

[GRAB LIMBS]

[EQUIP WT]

Wt Resistance

Bonus

Implements

Wt

Implements

Wt

Augments

[MAX AUGMENTS]

Cast Focuses

Wt

[GOLD]

[PACK WT]

Items

Wt

Items

Wt

STUDY



TINKER



PRACTICE



DEVELOP



TRAIN



ENHANCE



Skills

Ranks

Skills

Ranks



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## 4 Gameplay

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Gameplay in TRP is divided into *open* mode and *phased* mode.

### 4.1 Open mode

Unless the narrative of the game requires extended sequences of rapid action, it's best to keep the game in *open* mode.

Open mode consists of the GM describing a general setting, and the players asking questions to build on the setting and decide what to do. Whenever there's a questionable chance of success to something the players would like to do, the GM will ask them to make relevant rolls.

This is best illustrated with an example.

**GM:** As you enter the ruins, you notice the ground change beneath you, from soft dirt to sharp gravel. The sounds of wildlife grow eerily quiet.

Pillars of stone are arranged in a path to the temple, some of them are cracked and fallen. You see the mysterious door described by the pirates, but there's a pillar that has fallen over and is blocking it.

**Alice:** Huh. Can we see past the broken pillar?

**GM:** You can! The top half of the door is visible, but you can't see the inset for the key you found earlier.

**Eve:** I could move the pillar out of the way.

**Bob:** I could also try to worm my way past the pillar to reach the keyhole.

**Eve:** Oh! good point, maybe try that first.

**Bob:** I take the key and try to squeeze my way past the pillar.

**GM:** This requires grace of body. It's an extremely odd angle, so roll with {*dd2*}

---

ATHLETICS ROLL

---

**Bob:** R2a6{*dd2*} ⇒  
R2a4 -  

---

**Bob:** Awww, so close.

**GM:** You try several times, Bob, but you just can't squeeze in the key.

(continued...)

(...continued)

**Eve:** Let me move it for you, Bob.  
Could I lift the pillar up?

**GM:** Okay- That will require strength of body, and the pillar is incredibly heavy. I'd say it's nearly impossible to perform this task, and it has a risk of injury to body on failure. It would need a roll for  **FORTITUDE** with {*dd8*}.

**Alice:** I'd like to look for a broken piece of stone or something we could use as a wedge to make that easier. Doesn't seem right to risk getting injured before even starting this dungeon.

**GM:** Sure! That seems reasonable. Seems like Grace of Mind to find a clever way to use your surroundings to make this task easier. Roll me  **INSIGHT**.

## INSIGHT ROLL

**Alice:** R3a5 -   

**GM:** Great. Alice you notice that one side of the pillar is resting on the stone base on top of a shard of rock. A strong enough person should be able to knock out that rock and let the pillar roll aside. I'll say this brings down the difficulty of the task to hard- requiring {*dd4*}. You still risk injury on failure.

**Alice:** I suggest pushing out the rock to Eve.

**Eve:** I'll take Alice's suggestion.

**Bob:** Wait! We should all be able to do this together. I can help Eve push that rock.

**GM:** Sure! Eve give me a  **FORTITUDE** roll, and Bob give me a helping roll.

## FORTITUDE ROLL

**Eve:** R6a4{*dd4*} ⇒  
R6a0 -      

**Bob:** R2a3{*dd4*} ⇒  
R2d1 -  

**GM:** Wow! You both heave at the same time and manage to roll the pillar onto it's side so that there's more space near the door. Bob your earlier frustration with the pillar really comes out here and you help Eve bring it over the edge.

Note the back and forth between the GM and the players in this example. The GM poses a problem to the players- namely that there is a pillar blocking the keyhole to the door. The players propose various solutions to the problem, and can even add to the environment by asking

the GM about things that could plausibly exist.

As a GM, when a player suggests something, it behooves you to find something similar that could possibly work to keep the game going.

Below are some guidelines for assigning additional advantage and disadvantage based on the difficulty of the task:

Table 4a: Additional Advantage Guide

| DIFFICULTY                                | ADDL ADV |
|-------------------------------------------|----------|
| Near impossible to fail                   | {aa8}    |
| Very easy task                            | {aa6}    |
| Easy task                                 | {aa4}    |
| Task with a few situational advantages    | {aa2}    |
| Average Difficulty                        | {aa0}    |
| Task with a few situational disadvantages | {dd2}    |
| Hard task                                 | {dd4}    |
| Very hard task                            | {dd6}    |
| Near impossible task                      | {dd8}    |

### 4.1.1 Downtime

Downtime is a special part of *open* gameplay where a character takes care of slower tasks after the action for the day calms down. Downtime tasks are tasks that would typically take very long segments of in-game time, and so are reserved for when the action calms down.

Downtime consists of the following for each character:

1. Perform downtime actions - the GM must grant a minimum of 2 downtime actions. They may grant an additional bonus downtime action as appropriate, and rarely may grant 2 bonus downtime actions.

- If one of your actions is **not RECUPERATE**, deplete **one** Foundation of your choice (Mind, Body, Heart) **in addition** to **not** resetting your depleted fundamentals.

2. Choose character's loadout for the next day.

The possible downtime actions are listed below.

- **STUDY**– Roll **MEMORY**. Increment your study counter by the number of successes you get. When your study counter hits 12 - you reset it to 0 and create a new wt 0 cast focus of your choice (not automatically prepped).
- **SCAVENGE**– Roll **INTELLECT**. Gain scavenged loot of value equal to 100 gold times the number of successes you get. Ask your GM what loot you obtain.
- **TINKER**– Roll **INSIGHT**. Increment your tinker counter by the number of successes you get. When your tinker counter hits 12 you may either
  - Create a new item of craft grade 1
  - Create an upgrade that would increase the craft grade of another item by 1
  - Increase the amount of grade of a previously created upgrade by 1.

Upgrades may be applied immediately or at any point during freeform gameplay. You do not need to finalize the properties of the upgrade until your final application of the upgrade.

(continued...)

(…continued)

- **PRACTICE**– Roll  **DEXTERITY**. Increment your practice counter by the number of successes you get. When your practice counter hits 12, reset it to 0, and you may increase the rank of a skill that has 1 rank to 2 ranks. This may be a skill on either your own character, or on any character that has been nearby who you could have been practicing with.
- **DEVELOP**– Roll  **FORTITUDE**. Increment your Development counter by the number of successes you get. When your Development counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and grant yourself or any other player character close to you 1 XP.
- **TRAIN**– Roll  **ATHLETICS**. Increment your Training counter by the number of successes you get. When your Training counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and you may add 1 rank to a Skill that has no ranks in it. This may be a skill on either your own character, or on any character that has been nearby for significant periods of time who you ostensibly could have been practicing with.
- **EXPLORE**– Roll  **PERCEPTION**. If successful, Roll from the exploration table to determine a new area that your character discovers. You may adjust your table roll by a number up to the number of successes you got on the exploration roll.
- **ENHANCE**– Roll  **WILL**. Increment your Enhance counter by the number of successes you get. When your Augmentation counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and either
  - Add a new augment to your character or any nearby willing character.
  - Replace an augment on a character (yours or any nearby willing) with a different augment
  - Replace two augments with an attunement on your own character or any nearby willing character.
  - Replace an attunement with another attunement or two augments, on your own character or any nearby willing character. The affected character loses any XP invested in the original attunement.
- **SOCIALIZE**– Roll  **CHARISMA**. For each success on your roll, you may either
  - Obtain a piece of plot information from gossip or news.
  - Start a rumour that will reach a specific NPC your character is aware of.
  - Make an NPC who is negative towards your party neutral towards your party.
  - Make an NPC who is neutral towards your party positive towards your party.

You may not adjust the attitude of an NPC who is explicitly hostile towards your party.

(continued…)

(...continued)

- **SHOP**– Ask the GM if this action is available. Purchase equipment and sell equipment. By default, equipment sells for 50% of the price of new equipment. You may roll  **PERCEPTION** to find bargains and decrease the price of buying a piece of new equipment by 10% per success on your perception roll. You may roll  **CHARISMA** to sell your old equipment for higher prices and increase the price of selling a piece of equipment by 10% per success on your charisma roll.
- **CELEBRATE**– Ask the GM if this action is available. This action requires two or more player characters to perform this same action during the same downtime. The next day, all participating player characters will 1 bonus rank to their archetype.

## 4.2 Phased mode

When performing time sensitive tasks or entering contests or combat, the game enters phased mode.

The GM rotates through different phases where one party is on offense and the other parties are on defense.

Defenders choose their reactions first during a turn, and then offense chooses their actions.

The players within a party may choose their actions and reactions in any order, and do not need to wait until one player has completed all possible actions before performing their own.

### 4.2.1 Offense

By default, each character has three actions while on offense.

Your possible default actions are:

- Interact
- Apply talent
- Move
- Use other ability or item that is labeled “as an action” or “as an offensive action”

### 4.2.2 Defense

When you are defending, each character in the defending party must choose one reaction.

Your possible reactions are:

- Protect
- Retaliate
- Obstruct
- Dodge
- Use other ability or item that is labeled “as a defensive reaction”

For each of these, you must also specify your reaction trigger. Your choices of trigger are:

- an action taken against another character
- an action taken against your character
- a character entering a zone
- a character exiting a zone

A description of each of the options follows:



- **Defend**– may target any character or object within the same zone as you. Once triggered, for the rest of this turn any time an action is taken against the character or object you are protecting, you may contest your Athletics

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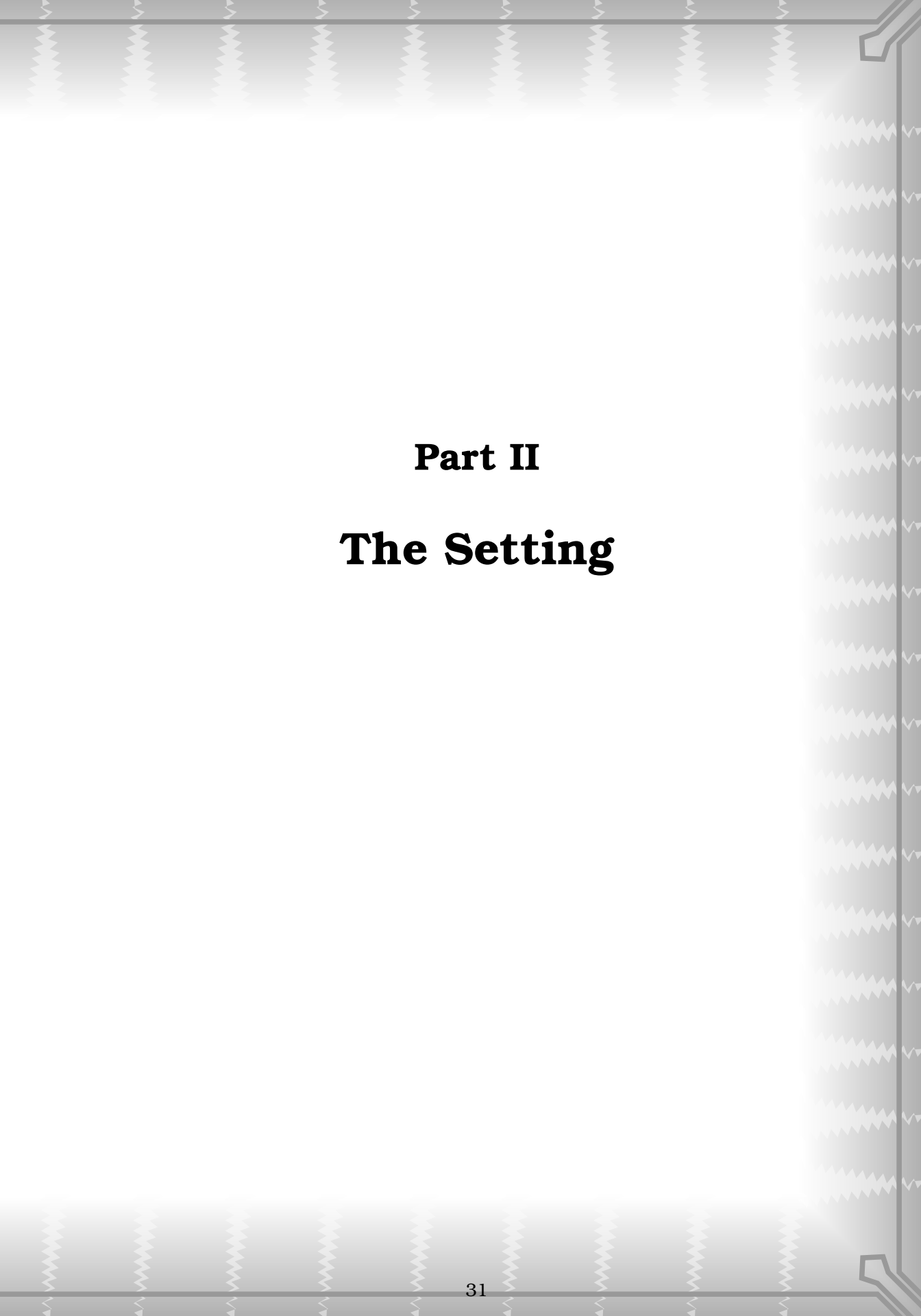
against the initiating character's roll to hit. If successful, the action is made to target you instead of its initial target.

- **Retaliate**– you may take one non-movement offensive action (as in the offense phase) in response to the trigger.
- **Dodge**– you may take one movement action in response to the trigger. If the trigger would incur damage to you, you may contest your Dexterity against the initiating character's roll to hit. If successful, you additionally avoid the damage in addition to taking a movement action.

On a tabletop- you have the choice of sharing your defensive action with the GM or of writing it on a card and turning it face down

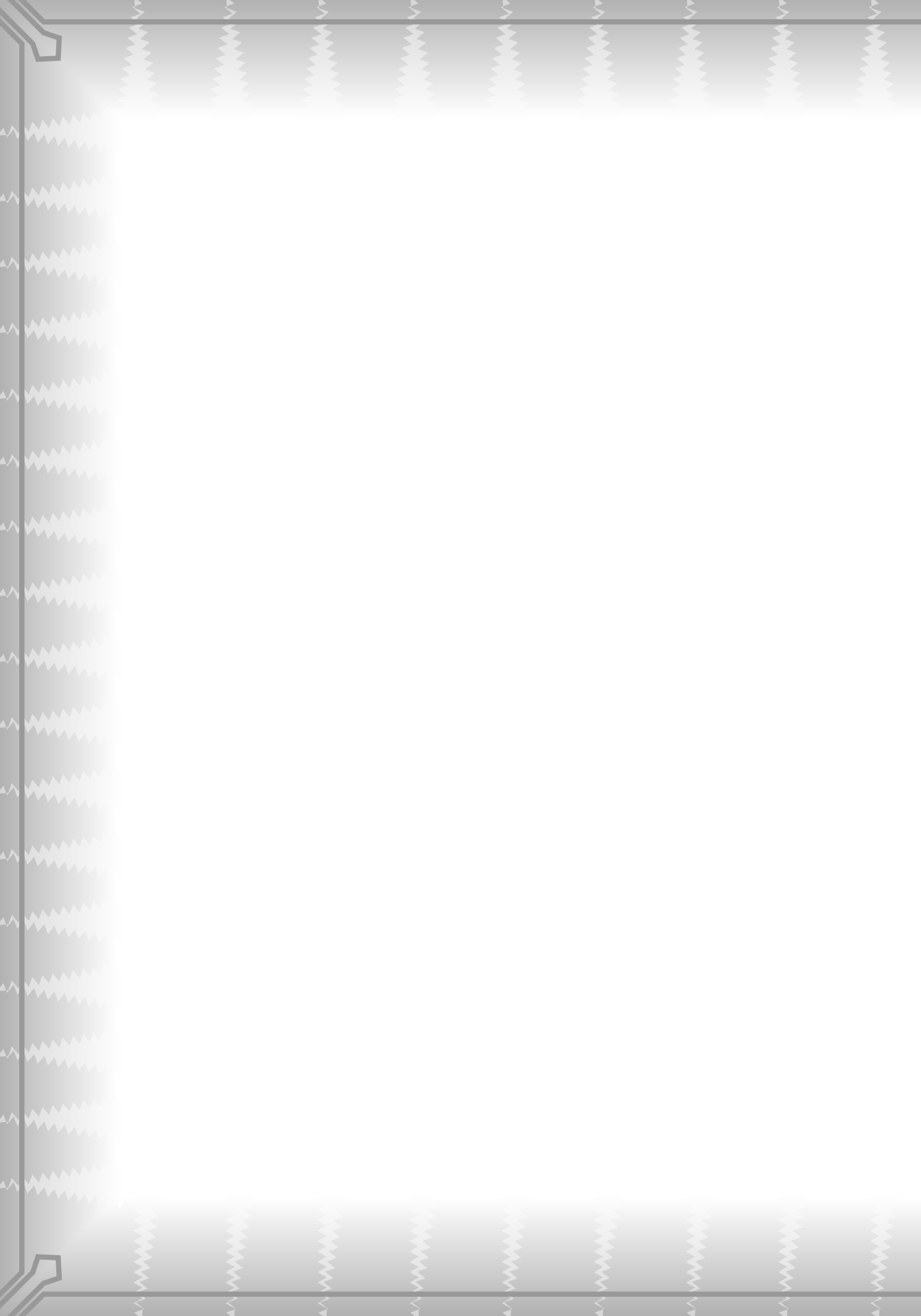
Communicating in a different language- penalty of 4 additional disadvantage? maybe





## **Part II**

# **The Setting**



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## Overview of the Gamma Nebula

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Gamma Nebula is a futuristic setting in another universe where advanced magic has enabled space exploration. The physics and the rules of the Gamma Nebula universe are very different to our own. Gamma Nebula has its own cosmology, history, and cultures, but a Game Master using the setting is encouraged to invent their own.

This book will lay out a framework of the galaxy and the way it works, but the details are left up to the Game Master and players, who may improvisationally create planets and peoples.

It's a big galaxy out there, with surprises and mysteries both ancient and new.

### **5.1 A brief history**

The Gamma Nebula setting takes place in a galaxy called the Great Spiral. There are currently approximately 100 known inhabited worlds in the great spiral governed by the Galactic Alliance, and linked through Fey Space by Fey Corridors.

More than 100,000 years ago, an event called The Great Collapse occurred that formed the universe. Scholars theorize that prior to this event, many of the planes that are currently wrapped into small dimensions used to be as accessible as the material plane, and that the universe was a much bigger place previously, though it may have been inhospitable to existence as we know it. The general consensus from both high level clerics and ancient artifacts obtained from Planar Pockets is that The Gods had something to do with this, and

that The Great Collapse and the creation of this universe was an attempt to prevent a great force of destruction from overcoming them and the life that came before.

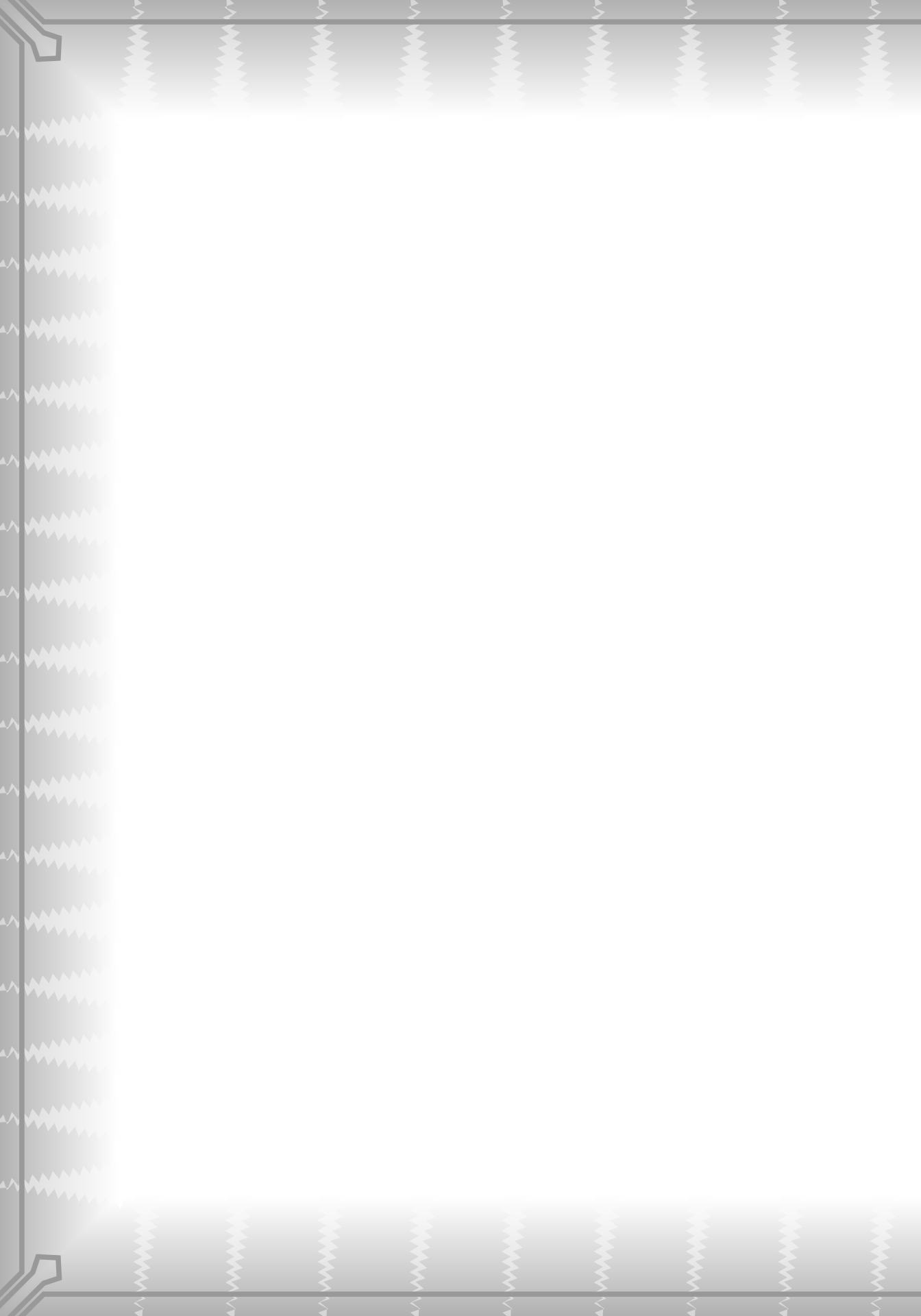
Within the first 10000 years after The Great Collapse the dragons built the Fey Corridor network. A flourishing galactic civilization of more than 2000 worlds was formed with numerous species using the network for communication and trade. The vast majority of the details of this civilization were lost during the Spiral War 40,000 years ago. All Fey Corridors were unusable for the first 1000 years after the Spiral War, and many Fey Corridor openings were completely destroyed or became permanently inoperable. Vast amounts of knowledge and technology were lost during that time. The technology used to create the Fey Corridors is slowly being rediscovered and some Fey Corridors are being restored. Unfortunately not all Fey Corridors can be restored because both ends of a Fey Corridor must be restored. For many known Fey Corridor openings, the location of another linked opening is not known and thus a viable corridor cannot be established. There are an estimated 1000 Fey Corridors that could be restored if the other opening could be physically accessed and repaired. These nonfunctioning Fey corridors are said to lead to Lost Worlds, which may very well harbor life and a society disconnected from the Galactic Alliance. There have been 3 Lost Worlds which have had a civilization which restored their side of a Fey Corridor Opening and rejoined the Galactic Alliance. All others have been restored from the side of the burgeoning Galactic Alliance.



# **Part III**

## **Appendices**





## Appendix: Mathematical Formulas

For the probability of success for a roll  $RXaY$ :

$$[\text{PROBABILITY}] = \begin{cases} \text{if } Y \geq 12, & 100\% \\ \text{if } 12 > Y > 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{12 - Y}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } Y = 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } 0 > Y \geq -X, & \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^{(-Y-1)} - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \times \left(\frac{10}{11}\right)^{(-Y-1)} \\ \text{if } -X > Y, & 0\% \end{cases} \quad (\text{Appendix:.1})$$



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